

## **Bridging Mentorship Guidelines**

### BRIDGING MENTORSHIP GUIDELINES

A framework for older adults mentoring high school graduates.

The "Bridging" phase (ages 17-19) is the most critical drop-off point for church attendance.

#### 1. The Goal of the Mentor

- You are not their parent, and you are not their peer. You are a trusted advisor.
- Your primary goal is to help them navigate the transition into adulthood.

#### 2. Time Commitment

- Meet once a month for coffee, lunch, or a walk.
- Send one check-in text every two weeks.
- Commit to a minimum of 12 months.

#### 3. Key Topics to Discuss

- Month 1-3 (Transition): Adjusting to college or the workforce.
- Month 4-6 (Identity): Navigating new friendships and relationships.
- Month 7-9 (Faith): Owning their own faith.
- Month 10-12 (Vocation): What is God calling them to do?

#### 4. Best Practices

- Listen more than you speak (80/20 rule).
- Share your own failures and struggles.
- Always pay for the coffee or the meal!